PRACTICE 04 · 10-MINUTE

The Guilt *Practice*

Guilt → **Release**

DURATION	WHEN	LEVEL	STEPS
10 minutes	*Any time*	*Beginner*	*3*

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Guilt is the feeling that you should have done something differently, even when no one is asking that of you. It often shows up after the moment has passed. In replaying conversations. In carrying responsibility that quietly grows heavier over time.

Guilt usually comes from care. From wanting to do right by others. From holding yourself to high standards. This practice is here to help you separate care from self-blame and let your body release what it's been holding.

> ***"I can care without punishing myself."***

A note before you begin.

This practiceonly workswhen you actually do it, not when you read about it. The shift happens in your body, not in your head. Trust what you feel during it, even if it surprises you.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- A quiet place to sit
- Something to track time
- A warm drink — tea, coffee, or cacao
- Something to write with
- 10 uninterrupted minutes

PRACTICE OVERVIEW

> Guilt isn't always about mistakes. More often it comes from over-responsibility. When you slow down and look at the thoughts driving it, you create room for something kinder without letting go of your values.

1	Thought Work	*6 min*
2	Qi Gong Shake	*1 min*
3	Close	*1 min*

THE PRACTICE

01 Thought Work

7 MINUTES

Guilt is a feeling, and feelings come from thoughts. Something occurs, your brain generates a thought about what it means ('I am bad for this', 'I let someone down'), that thought creates guilt, and the guilt drives behaviours like hiding, over-apologising, or spinning in the loop all day.

Mindfulness gives us the pause to step into the gap before the loop takes over. When we separate the facts of what happened from the story we've built around it, something shifts. We can move into accountability — honest and forward-moving — rather than staying in self-punishment.

1. BREATHE IN

Take three slow breaths. Each time you exhale, see if you can soften your stomach. Guilt tends to grip there.

You don't have to carry guilt in your body to prove you care. Your care is real. The suffering is a thought pattern, and thought patterns can be worked with.

2. FIND IT IN YOUR BODY

Without trying to change it yet, notice: Where am I holding guilt right now?

Maybe it's a heaviness in the chest. A hollow or knotted stomach. Heat in your face. A pull to make yourself smaller. Approach it with curiosity. You're not deciding the feeling is good or bad. You're simply recognising it.

3. WRITE YOUR THOUGHTS

Set a timer for 60-90 seconds. Let your brain say everything it's been repeating about what happened.

Now read it back. Look for the difference between the facts (what actually happened) and the story (what your brain has decided it means about you). Guilt lives in the story, not in the fact.

4. FIND A THOUGHT YOU CAN BELIEVE

Find the guilt thought carrying the most weight. Ask yourself: what would accountability without punishment look like here?

Some options to try:

"What I did and who I am are not the same thing."

"I can acknowledge this, learn from it, and move forward."

"I acted from where I was then. I can choose differently now."

"I don't have to keep suffering to prove I care."

02 Qi Gong Shake

1 MINUTE

Guilt tends to settle low in the body. Shaking is one of the most direct ways to discharge stored tension from the nervous system. Animals do this instinctively after stress. We've been taught to suppress it. This is you giving yourself permission to let it move through.

Qi Gong Shake · Demo video YouTube · ~1 minute youtu.be/ac3K83PQAsU

Stand comfortably. Begin gently shaking your hands, arms, shoulders, and legs. Let the movement be loose and unstructured. After about a minute, slow the movement and come to stillness.

03 Close

1 MINUTE

Placeonehandon your heart and take one slow breath. Take one final sip of your warm drink.

- "I'm allowed to learn and let it go."

PRACTICE COMPLETE

Today, you put down something that didn't need to be carried any longer.

Thatmatters. Responsibility doesn't requireself-judgment.Caredoesn'trequireweight.Returntothispractice whenever guilt starts quietly taking up space.

Creating inner balance, one gentle release at a time.

CONTINUE THE WORK

The Full Library. All five Practices.

Overwhelm isone layer.Pressure,self-doubt,uncertainty,andguilt are the others. The Full Library gives you a structured practice for each one.

stan.store/innerbalance101 →